

PREMIUM

Refusal Decision Guide

Administrative Review, CAS issues, and reapplying with a stronger case

Understand your options after a refusal

Outcome	What it means	What you can do
Refusal	The caseworker wasn't satisfied you met the points-based requirements - most commonly the financial evidence, a CAS/application mismatch, or the Genuine Student assessment.	In most cases, no formal right of appeal - your options are Administrative Review (only where a case-working error is claimed) or a fresh application.
Administrative Review	A review of whether the original decision contains a case-working error, requested within a set window of the refusal.	Available only in specific circumstances - read your refusal letter carefully for whether it's offered.
Reapplication	A new application, assessed fresh, generally requiring a new or reissued CAS.	The most common path - check with your sponsor whether your existing CAS can be reused or needs reissuing first.

If your CAS is involved

If the refusal cites a CAS/application mismatch, contact your sponsor's international office immediately - a CAS can sometimes be corrected or reissued, but this takes time, and a stale or incorrect CAS will cause the same problem again on reapplication.

If financial evidence was the issue

- Recheck the exact formula in the Financial Requirements Overview - a shortfall is often a specific, fixable calculation error rather than a general lack of funds
- Confirm your evidence covered the full, continuous 28-day period with no dip below the required amount
- Confirm the account type and currency were in an accepted form

If you were refused after a credibility interview

Read the refusal letter for the specific concerns raised about your Genuine Student assessment. A reapplication should directly and specifically address those concerns - vague reassurance without addressing the stated reason rarely succeeds.

What not to do

- Don't reapply with the same CAS and evidence unchanged
- Don't omit a previous refusal on a later application
- Don't submit a CAS or documents you know to be inaccurate to work around a previous refusal - this can lead to a longer-term ban on future applications

When to seek professional advice

Consider consulting an OISC-regulated immigration adviser or solicitor if you've been refused multiple times, if your case involves academic progression or switching-route complexity, or if you're unsure whether Administrative Review applies to your specific refusal reason.